

Fate's Edge – Player's Cyclopedia

1. The Core Loop

When you attempt a risky action:

1. **Declare** intent & approach (Attribute + Skill).
2. **GM sets** Difficulty Value (DV) and Position.
3. **Roll** dice pool: Attribute + Skill d10s.
4. **Count Successes**: each die $\geq 6 = 1$ success. Each die = 1 = 1 Story Beat (SB) for the GM.
5. **Compare** successes to DV $\rightarrow$ use Outcome Matrix.
6. **Apply** outcome; GM spends SB for complications.

2. Difficulty Value (DV)

Routine

Pressured (default)

Hard

Extreme

DV 2

DV 3

DV 4

DV 5+

3. Position (Risk)

Dominant

Re-roll one failure

Controlled

No re-rolls

Desperate

Re-roll one success

You may spend 1 Boon to improve Position by one step before rolling.

4. Outcome Matrix

Clean Success

successes $\geq$ DV, SB = 0 $\rightarrow$ intent achieved, no complication.

Success with SB

successes $\geq$ DV, SB > 0 $\rightarrow$ intent achieved; GM spends SB for twist.

Partial

0 < successes < DV $\rightarrow$ progress; you gain 1 Boon.

Miss

successes = 0 $\rightarrow$ no progress; you gain 2 Boons; GM escalates.

5. Boons (Player Currency)

- **Hold** up to 5. At end of scene, reduce to 2 (excess lost).
- **Earn**: Partial (1 Boon), Miss (2 Boons), bond-driven action, GM award.
- **Spend 1 Boon to**:
 - Re-roll a single die after seeing the pool.

- Improve Position by one step before rolling.
- Activate an on-screen Asset.
- Convert 2 Boons $\rightarrow$ 1 XP (once per session, max 2 XP).

6. Story Beats (GM Currency)

Each = 1 you roll gives the GM 1 SB. Spend SB to complicate the scene:
1 SB

Minor: noise, tick a timer, small setback.

2 SB

Moderate: alarm raised, lose advantage, worsen Position.

3+ SB

Major: reinforcements, scene shift, break an asset.

7. Fatigue & Harm

Fatigue: Each point worsens your Position (Dominant $\rightarrow$ Controlled $\rightarrow$ Desperate). If already Desperate, each Fatigue imposes -1 die.

- Fatigue track size = Body. When track fills $\rightarrow$ increase Harm by 1, clear all Fatigue.
- Short rest (1 hour) removes 2 Fatigue. Full night's rest removes all.

Harm 1

-1 die on related actions

Harm: Harm 2

-1 die on most actions

Harm 3

Incapacitated or dying

Taking Harm clears all existing Fatigue (the “roller-coaster” effect).

8. Combat Quick Reference

- **Turn**: 1 Action + 1 Move. Move shifts one range band (Close $\leftrightarrow$ Near $\leftrightarrow$ Far).
- **Opportunity Attack**: Leaving Close range without Disengage provokes one free melee attack.
- **Sidestrike**: Move one band as part of a melee attack; worsen Position by one step.
- **Shove**: Opposed Body+Athletics; push target one band.
- **Grapple**: Opposed Body+Melee; both Engaged; target suffers -1 die.

9. Essential Skills (Abridged)

Combat: Melee, Ranged, Brawl, Tactics.

Physical: Athletics, Stealth, Endurance, Craft, Survival.

Social: Sway, Command, Deception, Performance, Insight.

Knowledge: Lore, Investigation, Medicine.

Magic: Arcana, Ritual.

10. Making a Roll – Example

Dice pool = Attribute + Skill.

Success on 6+, SB on 1.

Example: Body 3 + Melee 2 = 5d10. Roll: 6,4,3,1,10 → successes: 6,10 (two successes, 10 counts as two) = 3 successes. SB: one 1 → 1 SB.

11. Quick DC & Effect Guidelines

DV 2	Routine, almost guaranteed.
DV 3	Standard pressured action.
DV 4	Hard, serious opposition.
DV 5+	Extreme, dramatic gamble.

Effect (scope of success): Limited (minor), Standard (expected), Great (ma-

jor). GM sets Effect based on fiction.

12. Critical Success (10s)

A roll of 10 counts as two successes. If the overall roll succeeds:

- One 10: Strong success – improve Position on next action or gain minor advantage.
- Two 10s: Exceptional – choose two benefits.
- Three 10s: Legendary – clear 1 segment from a relevant timer.

A 10 is never re-rolled, even by Position effects.

13. Boons vs. XP – A Reminder

Boons are dramatic fuel, not XP tokens. Spend them freely to re-roll, improve Position, or activate Assets. Hoarding Boons for conversion (2 Boons → 1 XP) slows the table's momentum. The real reward is agency, not a trickle of XP.

14. Golden Rule

When in doubt, make the choice that serves the story. If you cannot remember a rule, default to DV 3, Controlled Position, and let the dice fall.